

ness activities, yet building them into our daily lives is a challenge. Feeding into this need is Nagpur-headquartered NowZone. The start-up has developed a real-time breath monitoring device (global patent pending), which also contains, remarkably, Buddhist and Vedic teachings-based content for meditation, breath work, pranayama, yoga and even sleep stories.

“Nowfulness meditation is about experiencing the Middle Path, balancing the ‘What Is’ and ‘What If’ needs of current times based on science. Our device monitors breath in real time, notifying one-minute slow, deep breathing at 6 bpm (beats per minute), most needed when in stress,” says Akash Madnani, Founder and CEO of NowZone. So far, the start-up has received funding of over \$1 million from Tata 1mg, Dineout and Healthark Insights. It has sold over 5,000 devices, with a target of 10 million subscribers—including device sales—in the next five years. The current valuation of the start-up is ₹37.5 crore (\$5 million).

Another start-up, Gurugram-headquartered Pristyn Care, recently entered the unicorn club with a valuation of \$1.4 billion (₹10,963 crore) and investments of \$177 million (₹1,345 crore) from marquee investors like Sequoia Capital and Tiger Global, among others. The company specialises in elective surgeries using advanced treatments such as laser, laparoscopic treatment in ENT, urology, proctology and gynaecology, and kidney stones. It is also an end-to-end healthcare service provider (not an aggregator). Pristyn Care takes care of the patient through the treatment journey starting from the first OPD visit, diagnostics, admission, operation, post-op and IPD to insurance claims, discharge process, and follow-ups with



FY21 FUNDING LEADERBOARD

Healthtech start-ups are receiving steady funding because of their continued focus on making healthcare service delivery seamless for an underserved market

Start-up	Segment	Latest round (\$ mn)	Total funding (\$ mn)	Valuation (\$ mn)
Practo	Telemedicine	32	228.2	310
Medikabazaar	Marketplace	3.45	52.6	71.2
HealthPlix	Healthcare IT & analytics	13.5	23.50	NA
Tricog	Healthcare IT & analytics	10.5	17.5	NA
Phable	Telemedicine	12	13.70	13.10
Meddo	Telemedicine	3	6	12.10

SOURCE: RBSA ADVISORS

the surgeon. Besides, Pristyn Care has used technology to integrate its panel of doctors, partner hospitals, care coordinators and the insurance claims processing team. “We invest heavily in upgrading the idle, unutilised space in hospitals in metros and Tier II and Tier III cities and towns. We handhold them and set up systems, including creating a robust IT infrastructure there,” says Harsimarbir Singh, Co-founder of Pristyn Care.

Or take HealthPlix Technologies. The Bengaluru-headquartered Software-as-a-service (SaaS) platform for doctors recently released the mobile version of its AI-powered electronic medical records (EMR) app. ‘EMR on Mobile’ enables real-time access to patients’ information from anywhere, at any time. The app is built on the same architecture as the company’s flagship AI-powered desktop EMR. “This is not just a companion app to a web-based EMR. It is a standalone, mobile-first EMR packed with features meant for the Indian doctor. Any doctor in India can instantly unlock remote care

capabilities and adopt this EMR on the mobile with zero infrastructure requirements,” says Subhadeep Mondal, Vice President of Products at HealthPlix Technologies.

The mobile EMR has been accessed by doctors in over 350 cities, including Tier II and Tier III cities. In the wake of the Covid-19 pandemic, doctors can use ‘EMR on Mobile’ to manage both in-person and online consultations seamlessly across the same pool of patients. “We firmly believe doctors need agile and mobile-first solutions to drive better health outcomes,” says Burhanuddin Pithawala, Head of Growth Marketing at HealthPlix. The start-up is backed by Kalaari Capital, Lightspeed Ventures, Chiratae Ventures and JSW Ventures, and has raised \$23.5 million in funding till date.

While start-ups are bringing cutting-edge tech into healthcare to improve patient outcomes, a bigger push is needed to help them scale up to benefit a wider population. **BT**

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